

Daily Expense Tracker – Designing a 5-Second Expense Entry Experience

1. Problem Statement

Many users avoid tracking their daily expenses because existing apps require multiple steps, making the process time-consuming and tedious. This leads to inconsistent tracking and poor financial awareness.

2. Objective

To design a simple and efficient mobile interface that allows users to log their expenses in under 5 seconds with minimal effort.

3. Target Users

- Students and young adults
- Busy individuals with daily expenses
- Users who prefer quick and simple interactions

4. User Persona

Name: Meghana

Age: 20

Occupation: Student

Behavior:

- Spends money daily on food, travel, and shopping
- Does not consistently track expenses

Pain Points:

- Expense tracking apps feel complicated
- Too many input fields
- Takes too much time

Goal:

To log expenses quickly without interrupting daily activities

5. Key Pain Points Identified

- Too many steps to add an expense
- Small input fields and cluttered UI
- High cognitive load while entering details
- Lack of quick entry options

6. Proposed Solution

A minimal expense tracking application that focuses on speed and simplicity by:

- Reducing the number of steps required
- Providing a large input field for amount entry
- Offering quick category selection
- Keeping the interface clean and distraction-free

7. Features

- Quick expense entry (main feature)
- Daily expense summary
- Simple list of transactions

8. Wireframes

Low-fidelity wireframes were created to plan the layout and structure of the application. The focus was on organising elements to support fast and easy interaction.

Wireframes included:

- Add Expense screen layout
- Placement of category buttons
- Positioning of the save button

9. Final UI Design

The final interface was designed in Figma with a clean and minimal approach.

The design emphasises:

- Large, clear typography for amount entry
- Simple category selection using circular buttons

- A prominent action button for saving expenses
- Balanced spacing and alignment for better readability



This screen allows users to quickly enter an expense amount, select a category, and save it with minimal effort.



This screen displays the total expenses for the day along with a simple breakdown of categories.

10. Design Decisions

- Reduced steps to make expense entry faster
- Used large typography for better visibility
- Introduced category buttons to avoid typing
- Kept layout minimal to reduce confusion
- Focused on one main action (adding expense)

11. UX Principles Applied

- Simplicity
- Efficiency
- Accessibility
- Reduced cognitive load
- Clear visual hierarchy

12. Outcome

The final design allows users to quickly add expenses in a few seconds without unnecessary steps.

It improves usability and encourages consistent expense tracking.

13. Tools Used

- Figma (UI Design and Prototyping)

14. Conclusion

This project demonstrates how simplifying a user flow can significantly improve user experience.

By focusing on speed and clarity, the design makes expense tracking easier and more user-friendly.

